Debo Brand Book

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Debo is the new brand for the digital stamp card, replacing *Temelash*. It is built on the *debo* tradition (neighbours show up for each other, the host gives back) and one line: **Your loyalty is honoured.**

Home on the web: **joindebo.com**. The call to action everywhere: **Join Debo.**

Positioning

Debo is the digital stamp card for Ethiopia's neighbourhood businesses: every return visit is noticed, and every full card is honoured.

Positioning statement. For cafés, salons, spas, restaurants and car washes that live on regulars, Debo is the stamp card on the customer's phone that turns return visits into rewards. Unlike paper cards, it cannot be lost, faked or left at home, and it shows the owner who keeps coming back.

Name	**Debo** (ደቦ / *Daboo*): neighbours helping each other, with the host giving back
Tagline	**Your loyalty is honoured.**
Category	Digital stamp card. Not points, not payments
For	Customers who return to the same shops; owners of single- and multi-branch local businesses
Core promise	You show up, the shop remembers, and the shop gives back
Why believe it	One stamp per visit, set by the shop; works offline; one wallet for every shop; owners see who came back
Different from	Paper cards (lost, faked), discount apps (race to the bottom), points schemes (confusing, feel like money)
Personality	Warm, respectful, straightforward, proudly local
Web and call to action	joindebo.com · Join Debo

Brand story

The story is the *debo*: neighbours show up for each other, and the host honours them with a feast. Debo brings that promise to the counter.

Long version (website, launch, pitch deck)

In Ethiopia, no family brings in a harvest or raises a roof alone. They call a *debo*. Neighbours come with their hands and their time until the work is done. When the last bundle is tied, the host keeps a promise as old as the tradition: a feast for everyone who came. Nobody writes down who showed up, but everyone remembers, and next season the host goes to help them.

Debo brings that promise to the café on your corner, the salon you trust, the car wash you always use. Every visit is you showing up. Every stamp is the shop remembering. When your card is full, the shop hosts the feast: your free coffee, haircut or wash. **Your loyalty is honoured.**

Short version (app store, about screen, posters)

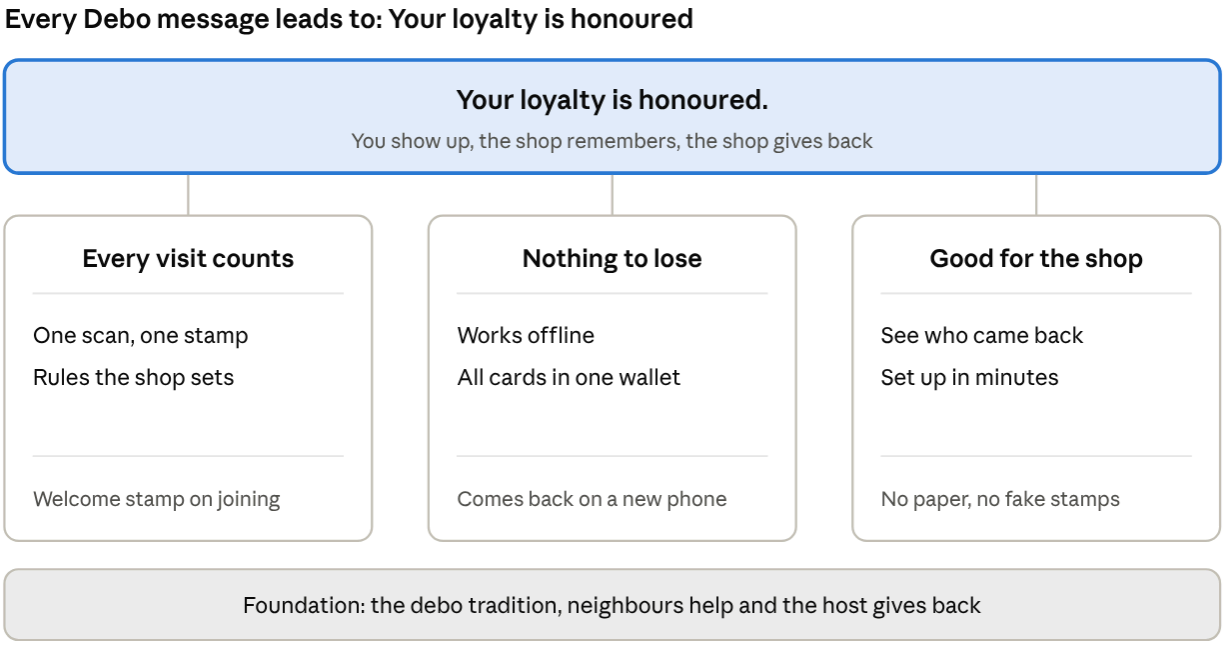
You keep coming back to the places you love. Debo makes sure they notice. Every visit earns a stamp, and every full card earns a reward. Your loyalty is honoured.

Owner version (sales visit, owner app)

Your regulars are your business. Debo gives them a reason to choose you again, and shows you who keeps coming back. No paper cards to print, lose or fake: customers scan your poster, your team stamps from a phone, and you see every visit.

The tradition	In Debo
Neighbours come to help	The customer visits
Everyone remembers who came	Staff add a stamp
The work is done	The card is full
The host gives the feast	The customer gets the reward
Next season, again	A new card starts

Message house



message house · tagline, promise, 3 pillars, foundation

Every message picks one pillar, gives its proof, and ends on the tagline.

Audiences

Debo speaks to three people at one counter: the customer, the owner and the cashier. Each hears the same promise from their own side.

Audience	Who they are	What they want	What Debo says	Where they meet us
Customers	Regulars at cafés, salons, spas, restaurants, car washes; mostly young, urban, on a phone	To feel noticed; a reward that is real and easy	Your visits count, and the shop gives back	Join poster, counter, customer app, SMS
Owners	Run one shop or a few branches; time-poor; count every Birr	More regulars, no fraud, little effort	Your regulars are your business; Debo keeps them coming	Sales visit, agent, owner app, reports

Audience	Who they are	What they want	What Debo says	Where they meet us
Staff	Cashiers and front-desk staff, on the shop's phone	Stamping that is fast and clear, no arguments	One scan, one stamp; the app decides	Staff app, owner's training

Voice and tone

Debo sounds like a good host: warm, respectful and to the point. It thanks people, it never pushes them.

We are	So we	We are not	So we never
Warm	Thank and welcome: "Welcome back!"	Cold or corporate	Say "Transaction recorded"
Respectful	Use the polite form in Amharic (-ዎ) and Oromo (*isin*)	Familiar or cute	Use slang, nicknames or emoji in the product
Straightforward	Short sentences, one idea, plain words: "3 more visits to your free coffee"	Salesy	Use "Amazing deals!", hype or pressure
Local	Use Ethiopian examples, Birr, East Africa Time, Ethiopian dates	Imported	Talk in dollars, "points" or foreign holidays
Honest	Say what happens: "Stamps sync when you are back online"	Vague	Promise what the shop sets (rewards, timing)

Tone by moment

- **Joining:** welcoming, light. "You are in! Your welcome stamp is already on your card."
- **Stamping:** quick, cheerful, one line. "Stamp added. 2 more to go."
- **Reward:** the feast moment, the warmest we get. "Your card is full. Your loyalty is honoured."
- **Errors and limits:** calm, no blame, say the next step. "Already stamped for this visit. Come back next time."
- **Owners:** practical and businesslike, numbers first.

Logo and mark

The logo is the word **debo** with its final *o* drawn as a filled stamp: the last visit that completes the card. This is a design brief, not final artwork; a designer draws it.

- **Wordmark (Latin):** `debo` in lower case, Lato Black, tight but not touching. The final *o* is a solid circle in Debo Red, the stamp.
- **Wordmark (Ethiopic):** `ደቦ` in Noto Sans Ethiopic Bold, same height, with the same red stamp dot after it. Shown alone on Amharic material, side by side with the Latin one on shared material.
- **Symbol (app icon, favicon, stamp):** a ring of small circles closing into one full red circle, like neighbours gathering at a table. Reads at 16 px as a red dot in a ring.
- **Lock-up with tagline:** wordmark, then *Your loyalty is honoured.* below in Lato Regular at 40% of the wordmark height.
- **Clear space:** the height of the stamp *o* on every side. **Smallest size:** 72 px wide on screen, 20 mm in print.

Misuse: never

- write it in capitals (DEBO) or as *DeboCard*
- stretch, outline, add shadows or gradients
- recolour the stamp in anything but Debo Red, or put it on red
- add a coffee cup, scissors or other trade symbol: Debo is for every business

Colour

The palette is the app's existing colour tokens (`packages/ui/tokens.css`), named for the brand, so the apps need no colour changes. Mostly light and calm, with red kept for the stamp and gold for the reward.

Brand name	Hex	Token	Use	Share
Debo Night	#101827	`--tc-navy`	Wordmark, headlines, dark posters	20%
Debo Red	#e42330	`--tc-red`	The stamp, the logo's *o*, one key action	5%
Feast Gold	#fba919	`--tc-amber`	Rewards and full cards only	5%
Neighbour Blue	#4661ad	`--tc-blue`	Links, secondary highlights	5%

Brand name	Hex	Token	Use	Share
Paper	#f3f3f3	`--tc-bg`	Backgrounds	45%
White	#ffffff	`--tc-surface`	Cards and panels	15%
Ink	#444444 / #595959	`--tc-text` / `--tc-text-muted`	Body text	Text

Rules

- Red means "a stamp happened". Do not use it for decoration, and never for errors (errors use `--tc-error` #b3261e).
- Gold means "the feast". Keep it for rewards so it still feels special.
- Text on Paper or White uses Night or Ink. White text only on Night.

Typography

Two free fonts cover all three languages: **Lato** for English and Oromo, **Noto Sans Ethiopic** for Amharic. They are already the apps' fonts.

Role	Latin (English, Oromo)	Ethiopic (Amharic)	Use
Wordmark	Lato Black	Noto Sans Ethiopic Bold	Logo only
Headline	Lato Bold	Noto Sans Ethiopic Bold	Posters, screen titles
Body	Lato Regular	Noto Sans Ethiopic Regular	Everything else
Numbers	Lato Bold, tabular	Lato Bold, tabular	Stamp counts, Birr, dates

Rules

- Amharic needs about 15% more size and more line height than Latin to read the same; never shrink it to fit a layout made for English.
- Oromo words run long ("badhaasa", "amanamummaan"): design for 30% longer lines than English.
- Sentence case everywhere. Capitals only for short field labels the apps already use ("PHONE NUMBER").
- Numbers are always Western digits, so counts read the same in every language.

Imagery, motion and applications

Debo shows real people at real Ethiopian counters, and saves its brightest moment for the full card.

Photography

- Real local shops, owners and regulars, in natural light: a barista handing over a macchiato, a stylist with a regular, a car-wash crew.
- People and hands in the frame, a phone visible but never the hero.
- Never stock photos of foreign cafés, cash, or shopping bags.

Motion

- The stamp landing and the full-card celebration are the brand's two signature moments. Both already exist in `packages/ui/motion.css` (from the prototype); use those, with their reduced-motion fallbacks, and no new animations.
- Staff and owner apps use the calmer `-work` variants. Admin has none.

Applications

Item	What it carries
Join poster (A4, A3)	Shop logo, the reward ("Free coffee at 8 stamps"), the QR code, "Scan to join" with joindebo.com under it, Debo logo small at the bottom
Counter stand	Same as the poster, folded; QR at eye level for the cashier's side
App icon	The symbol: ring of circles closing into the red stamp, on White
Welcome SMS	"Welcome to {shop} on Debo. Your loyalty is honoured."
Window sticker	"We honour our regulars. Join Debo at the counter."
Sales leave-behind	Owner version of the story, what it costs, the owner app's Today screen, joindebo.com

The shop's own name and logo lead on everything a customer sees in the shop; Debo signs underneath, like the host and the tradition.

Taglines and headlines

Your loyalty is honoured. is the one tagline: it goes with the logo everywhere. The lines below are headlines for particular places, never replacements.

Where	Line
Logo lock-up, app store, every campaign end	Your loyalty is honoured.
Join poster	Scan. Collect. Be honoured.
Customer launch	The old way of giving back, in your pocket.
Reward screen	Your card is full. Your loyalty is honoured.
Owner sales	Your regulars are your business.
Owner sales, alternative	Honour your regulars. Watch them come back.
Window sticker	We honour our regulars.
Social, short	Show up. Get honoured.
Call to action (buttons, posters, ads, app store)	Join Debo
Sign-off on every ad and print item	Your loyalty is honoured. joindebo.com

Messages by audience

Every message comes back to one idea: you show up, the shop remembers, the shop gives back. Proof points are things the product already does.

Customers

1. **Every visit counts.** One scan at the counter adds your stamp.
2. **All your cards in one place.** Every Debo shop in one wallet on your phone.
3. **Nothing to lose.** No paper card to forget; it works offline and comes back on a new phone.
4. **Your data is yours.** We never sell it, and you can delete your account any time.

Owners: the pitch in four lines

1. Your regulars are your business. Debo gives them a reason to come back.
2. Set it up in minutes: choose your reward, print your poster, add your team.
3. No fake stamps: one stamp per visit, on rules you set.

4. See who came back, every day, in your owner app.

Owners: answers to common objections

They say	We say
"I already have paper cards."	Paper gets lost, copied and forgotten at home. Debo cannot be faked, and you see every visit.
"My staff will give stamps to friends."	Each stamp is tied to a staff account and a visit. You set the time between stamps, and every stamp is in your activity log.
"The internet here is bad."	Stamping works offline and syncs when the connection is back.
"It is one more thing for my team."	One scan per customer. Your team signs in with a phone number and PIN you give them.
"What if I want to stop?"	You keep your reports and can download your customer list.

Staff

- One scan, one stamp. The app decides if a stamp is allowed, so you never have to argue.
- If the customer was already stamped, the app tells them kindly: "Come back next time."

Key lines in three languages

The Amharic and Oromo lines are drafts; a native speaker must check each one before it goes on anything public.

English	Amharic (draft)	Oromo (draft)
Debo	ደቦ	Debo
Your loyalty is honoured.	ታማኝነትዎ ይከበራል።	Amanamummaan keessan ni kabajama.
Scan to join	ለመቀላቀል ይቃኙ	Makamuuf iskaanii godhaa
Your card is full.	ካርድዎ ሞልቷል።	Kaardiin keessan guutameera.
Welcome back!	እንኳን ደህና መጡ!	Baga nagaan deebitan!
We honour our regulars.	ደንበኞቻችንን እናከብራለን።	Maamiltoota keenya ni kabajna.
Join Debo	ደቦን ይቀላቀሉ	Debo'tti makamaa

Words we use and avoid

The words keep Debo about visits and honour, never about money.

Use	Avoid	Why
stamp	point, credit	A stamp is a visit; points sound like money
reward, your free coffee	prize, cashback, discount	It is a gift from the shop, not a price cut
honoured, remembered	earned, redeemed	Honour is the brand; "redeem" is banking talk
card, your Debo card	DeboCard, account balance	The name is Debo alone; there is no balance
regulars, customers	users, consumers	People, not data
shop, business	merchant, vendor	Plain words owners use
visit	transaction	Same reason

Open questions

Debo was found already in use, so the trademark check comes before any money is spent on artwork or print.

- [ ] **Trademark:** EIPA search for *Debo* in classes 35, 9 and 42, and a check on who already uses it. If a nearby Ethiopian business holds it, the brand needs a new name; the story, tagline and identity carry over.
- [ ] **Domain and handles:** register joindebo.com (the brand's home) and debo.com.et now, and point debocard.com at them. Taken: debo.com (for sale through a broker), getdebo.com (a software company abroad) and debo.et (owner unknown; find out who holds it). Still to check: @joindebo on Telegram, Instagram and TikTok, and "Debo" in the app stores.
- [ ] **Wording sign-off:** Truman owns wording; this book needs his OK.
- [ ] **Native review:** every Amharic and Oromo line here.
- [ ] **Logo artwork:** a designer draws the wordmark and symbol from the brief above.
- [ ] **Renaming the apps:** screens, SMS texts and the join poster still say Temelash; they change once the name is cleared.